ASCII MASTER FLOW

Indian States & Society in the Eighteenth Century (Marathas, Sikhs, successor states)

Modern History Topic 02 | 12 synchronised panels

PANEL 1/12: Eighteenth-century frame: crisis and reordering

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MUGHAL CENTRE CONTRACTS -> provincial, confederate and local arenas gain leverage
CORE QUESTION -> how revenue, armed labour, credit and legitimacy form regional states
TWO ERRORS -> pure chaos / universal prosperity
VERDICT -> uneven state formation, commercial continuity and social cost coexist.
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PANEL 2/12: Three state types, not one hierarchy

SUCCESSOR -> Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad: Mughal office becomes practical autonomy
AUTONOMOUS / REGIONAL -> Mysore, Travancore, Rajput houses: older fields centralise selectively
NEW / MOBILISED -> Marathas, Sikhs, Jats, Rohillas: armed networks and local solidarities
RULE -> origin category does not predetermine capacity or welfare.

PANEL 3/12: Regional chronology and bounded sequence

1707-20 -> succession, Shahu-Tarabai conflict and Banda Bahadur (Khalsa 1699 legacy)
1719 -> Mughal sanads legalise Maratha chauth/sardeshmukhi in six Deccan provinces
1728 -> Palkhed forces Nizam-ul-Mulk to reaffirm the 1719 Maratha claims
1761 -> Panipat III checks the Maratha northern bid; recovery follows by 1771.

PANEL 4/12: Hyderabad, Awadh, Bengal and Arcot compared

HYDERABAD -> Nizam-ul-Mulk turns subedari and military authority into autonomy (1724)
AWADH -> Saadat Khan / Safdar Jang work through chiefs, taluqdars and imperial office
BENGAL -> Murshid Quli Khan and successors concentrate revenue and banking links (1717)
ARCOT -> Nizamat of Arcot descends from the Hyderabad hierarchy, not a separate origin.

PANEL 5/12: Maratha confederacy: reach and coordination

SATARA / POONA -> chhatrapati, Peshwa and negotiated leadership since 1713
CHAUTH + SARDESHMUKHI -> 1719 sanads legalise the claim; local collection still varies
SCINDIA / HOLKAR / GAEKWAD / BHONSLE -> expanding houses and regional bases
TRAP -> neither a unitary nation-state nor only raiding; coordination had limits.

PANEL 6/12: Sikhs: community, mobilisation and misls

KHALSA LEGACY (1699) -> persecution, mobilisation and armed community formation
BANDA BAHADUR (1709-15) -> faujdars, diwan, seal and coin; captured/executed 1715-16
DAL KHALSA / MISLS -> fluid armed-territorial networks in Punjab
BOUNDARY -> Ranjit Singh belongs only as a later, 1799-bounded consolidating bridge.

PANEL 7/12: Mysore, Rajputs and Jats: bounded comparisons

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MYSORE -> Haidar Ali (1755 Dindigul arsenal, 1761 control); Tipu bounded, not owned here
RAJPUT STATES -> Sawai Jai Singh II's 1727 Jaipur/Jantar Mantar; court, tribute, diplomacy
JATS -> agrarian-zamindari mobilisation around Bharatpur and Suraj Mal
RULE -> compare resource route and legitimacy; avoid a single 'rebel state' label.
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PANEL 8/12: State-formation engine and banker-state link

REVENUE ASSESSMENT + INTERMEDIARIES -> treasury and credit
JAGAT SETH (Bengal treasurer from c.1730) -> named evidence: credit converted to political leverage
ARMY -> enforces revenue and rewards clients -> court and patronage become durable
LIMIT -> warfare and extraction can strengthen rulers while burdening cultivators.

PANEL 9/12: Society: hierarchy with differentiated agency

CASTE / CLASS / REGION -> condition access to land, work, honour and mobility
WOMEN -> Tarabai, Ahilyabai Holkar show elite agency; ordinary labour needs cautious reconstruction
PEASANTS -> production base facing varied rents, dues, credit and war disruption
SOLDIERS / OFFICIALS -> selective mobility (e.g. Holkar rise) without dissolving hierarchy.

PANEL 10/12: Commercialisation links town and countryside

PEASANT SURPLUS -> markets, revenue and military supply
ARTISANS -> textiles, arms and specialised work | MERCHANTS -> brokerage and trade
BANKERS / HUNDIS -> Jagat Seth-style credit and long-distance remittance
QUALIFY -> commercial dynamism does not prove equal prosperity or secure cultivation.

PANEL 11/12: Culture and institutional continuity

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PERSIANATE COURTS + regional languages -> administrative and literary continuity
COURTS / TOWNS -> Kangra, Lucknow, Hyderabad-Arcot and Travancore patronage shift regionally
MUGHAL SYMBOLS -> titles, coin, khutba and records remain politically usable
VERDICT -> cultural production persists amid war, hierarchy and changing patrons.
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PANEL 12/12: Topic 02 answer spine and boundary/PYQ anchors

CLASSIFY -> successor / autonomous-regional / newly mobilised states; COMPARE named rulers
EXPLAIN -> administration, revenue, army, credit and local alliances; INTEGRATE society/economy
BOUNDARY -> Topic 01 = imperial-decline causation; Topic 03/05 = European rivalry/conquest;
  Medieval 25 = pre-1761 continuity; Medieval 24 = 2021 Q45 administrative-hierarchy recall.
PYQ -> direct: 2021 Prelims Q48 only. Adjacent: 2021 Q45, 2022 GS-I Q2. 2026 Prelims/Mains: zero.